



Deciding the perfect NAS for you

With so many choices to pick from you need to take into account what all parameters are absolutely essential for choosing the right NAS device and here is how you go about picking one for your home or your office.

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There are plenty of factors when it comes to picking the right NAS device and for the sake of simplicity we've broken them down for your convenience. Obviously, getting a NAS device which acers through all these categories would be undoubtedly expensive so do keep that in mind when you are finalising what to buy.

Hard Drive

The brand you need to pick should be power efficient, come in different form factors and capacities, remain cooler and feature a firmware optimised for NAS usage. There are a few brands that have such specialised hard drives. One of the important factors when deciding on a hard drive is whether it is supported by the NAS manufacturer and this is where popular brands excel because pretty much every manufacturer out there supports their full portfolio of hard drives.

Storage Capacity

Each NAS device has a certain upper limit when it comes to the total capacity of each drive as well as all drives combined. Now this will only be an issue if you opt for the most basic model available so do check the packaging to figure out if there is such a limit and also research online. Often, each bay will support a maximum of 4TB



The back of the NAS is apparently a bigger deciding factor and this is why

which is the highest HDD capacity currently available.

Bays

NAS devices often have support for RAID which means they will support a minimum of two hard drives and thus, there will be at least two bays. Having more bays also allows for redundancies. So whenever any of your hard drives go out of action then you can easily swap them out without loss of data, i.e. provided you choose a RAID level that supports redundancy like RAID 1.

Formfactor

Hard drives are available in 2.5 inch form factors as well as the traditional 3.5 inch form factor. The smaller form factor drives are comparatively expensive and storage capacity is also limited to 2TB which is why the 3.5 inch drives are still the rage when it comes to picking one for your

NAS. But most NAS will have bays that have screw holes for installing the smaller 2.5 inch form factor drives as well.

SSD support

SSDs are available in large capacities but the cost per GB is still quite high compared to hard drives but most NAS that do support SSDs use them as a cache drive to speed up data transfer between the NAS and your computer.

Hardware Processor

The processing power comes into play when you need to cater to a lot of users/clients downloading different sets of files simultaneously. So a NAS device with an Intel Atom processor should be more than sufficient for the average home/small office. If you expect a lot more clients to be connected on a regular basis then you might consider having a dual core Atom processor or one of